Below are **copy-paste prompt templates** for various stages of short-form video creation. You can fill in the `[blanks]` with your details:

- **Brainstorm Video Ideas:**
  "You are a social media expert. Generate 5 ***creative TikTok/Reel ideas*** *about* ***[your topic]*** *that would appeal to* ***[target audience]****. Each idea should be one sentence describing the concept, with a* ***[desired tone]*** *and a clear hook in the first 3 seconds."*
  Why it works: Setting the role ensures expertise, and the prompt asks for a list of ideas with a hook (crucial for TikTok). The output will be concise ideas ready to execute.

- **Developing a Story Outline:**
  "You are a skilled storyteller. I want to create a short video in the ***[genre]*** *genre. Outline a* ***beginning, middle, and end*** *for a* ***[duration]*** *second video about* ***[brief premise]****. The main character is* ***[describe protagonist]*** *and the conflict is* ***[describe conflict]****. Provide the outline as 3 bullet points (setup, confrontation, resolution) in a* ***[tone]*** *style."*
  Example: "Outline a beginning, middle, end for a 30s fantasy video where a shy teen discovers they have magical powers – tone should be adventurous and uplifting."
  Why it works: It explicitly asks for a structured outline, ensuring the story beats are covered succinctly.

- **Character or Setting Description (for Visuals):**
  "You are an imaginative novelist helping with video pre-production. Describe the ***appearance and personality*** *of a character for a short video:* ***[brief context: e.g., 'a 25-year-old street artist in a cyberpunk city']****. Include vivid details that could inspire visuals (clothing style, expressions, environment). Provide 5-6 sentences."*
  Why it works: This prompt yields a rich description that can guide wardrobe, art style or be used to generate AI images of the character.

- **Scriptwriting (Dialogue or Voiceover):**
  "You are a screenwriter. Write a ***[duration]-second script*** *for a* ***[tone] [genre]*** *TikTok video about* ***[scenario]****. Include conversational dialogue between characters [or a voiceover monologue], with a clear beginning, build-up, and twist ending. Use no more than* ***[X]*** *words."*
  Example: "Write a 45-second comedic script of two siblings trying to bake a cake in real-time, with snappy, funny dialogue and a surprise fail at the end."
  Why it works: It specifies duration, genre, scenario, and even the structure (twist ending), so ChatGPT will produce a fitting mini-script. Specifying word count or time ensures it fits short-video length (~150 words ~ 1 minute when spoken).

- **Visual Shot List / Storyboard Ideas:**
  "You are a video director. Break down a ***[duration]-second [genre]*** *video into a shot list. The video topic:* ***[describe concept]****. Provide 5-7 shots with brief descriptions: mention camera angle/movement and the main action in each shot."*
  Example: "Break down a 15s travel Reel about Paris into a shot list. Include angles like POV, wide shot, close-up, and describe what happens in each."
  Why it works: This prompt asks for a sequence of shots, which helps plan the visuals. ChatGPT can suggest e.g. "Shot 1: Wide shot of Eiffel Tower at sunrise – **slow pan** to reveal crowd. Shot 2: Close-up of croissant and coffee on café table…" etc. It's great for visualizing the flow before production.

- **AI Image Prompt Generation:** (Yes, you can even use ChatGPT to help craft prompts for image generators!)
  "You are an AI image prompt generator. Based on this video scene – ***[describe scene or mood]*** *– create a detailed Stable Diffusion prompt to visualize it. Include style and aspect ratio 9:16 for vertical video."*
  Example: "Generate an image prompt for: 'A girl discovers a hidden portal in a garden at night' –

include fantasy art style, dramatic lighting."
Why it works: ChatGPT will output something like: *"A moonlit victorian garden with glowing portal among rose bushes; a young girl in awe stands before it – **cinematic lighting**, art by Studio Ghibli, **–ar 9:16**"*. This can be copied into Stable Diffusion or Midjourney. It's an efficient way to get well-phrased image prompts.

Tips: Always review and tweak ChatGPT's output. It's smart but not perfect. If a script is too long or the idea isn't catchy enough, ask follow-ups like *"Make it shorter and punchier"* or *"Give alternative endings."* By iterating, you can arrive at a story or script that **sticks** with the audience. Remember that on TikTok/Reels, **keeping attention is key** – use ChatGPT to brainstorm a strong hook (first 2-3 seconds) for every idea. For example, ask *"Suggest a catchy opening line or action for this video"*. According to marketing insights, those first moments must *"bring on mesmerizing visuals"* or intrigue to hook viewers – ChatGPT can help script that hook explicitly.